



Nauru



New Zealand

Papua New
Guinea

Samoa



Solomon Islands



Tonga



Tuvalu



Vanuatu



Teaching in Tonga

Tonga is one of the independent nations among the Pacific islands of Oceania. English and Tongan are the two official languages for the small population of around 106,000. In Tonga, children have to go to school between the ages of five and eighteen.



First people

These people were some of the first settlers in Australasia and Oceania.



Pacific islander

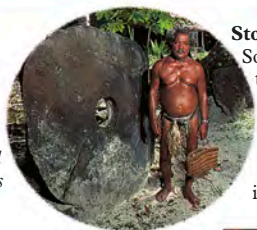
Papua New Guinea
tribesman

Maori woman



Aboriginal tribesman

This boy has Vietnamese parents. English is his second language, just as it is for one in five other Australians.



Stone money

Some Pacific island tribal traditions have not changed for thousands of years.

The people of Yap island still use stones like this one as money when they make important property deals.

This girl's parents are Chinese. Many Australians are of Asian descent.



Rugby dance

The Maoris settled in New Zealand about 1,000 years ago. The New Zealand rugby team, the All Blacks, has borrowed some Maori traditions. They use an old Maori war chant, called a haka, to get them in the mood for matches.

Surfing is popular along the coast of Australia.

